

Mitsue Project — Presenter Notes

"The forest our ancestors planted — the power that sustains the village they built" 先人が植えた森が、今、村を支える力になる。

1 • Title

- 25-year plan, small mountain village
- Forest · EV power · AI

2 • The Setting

- Vacant former Sugano school (Koryukan) + tired forest + fragile grid
- Pop ≈1,400, forest cover ≈93%
- If it works here, copy elsewhere

3 • Four Pressures

- Energy: EVs need rural charging
- Forest: cedar = liability + fuel
- Stranded: former Sugano school building
- Digital: rural compute is thin

4 • The Idea

- Forest + power + compute, one ledger
- Each part funds/feeds the others

5 • Forest Restoration

- Sugi → native broadleaf, 25-yr cycle
- Removed cedar = biomass fuel
- Acorns feed wildlife, keeps them off farms

6 • Local Energy & EV

- Biomass (from forest) + solar + battery
- Grid = backup only
- Keeps school/clinic running in blackouts

7 • Community Data Center

- Former Sugano school → small edge data center
- 100% local renewable power
- Village owns it, heat reused for greenhouses

8 • Benefits

- Community: jobs, EV charging, resilient clinic
- Environment: less pollen, less landslide risk
- Beyond Mitsue: open, replicable template

9 • Where We Are Today (May 2026)

- Phase 0, quiet, self-funded
- Advisors: Ray Ozzie, Takuo Dome, Evin Zoet, Yoshiko Zoet-Suzuki
- Next: Japanese co-founder, meet Mayor, charter

10 • Phases & Gates

- 5 phases, 4 funding gates
- Miss a gate → pause, don't rush
- Year-3 target ≈ ¥134M

11 • Village RE Plan Alignment

- We execute the village's own 2025 RE plan
- EV charging priority, forest J-Credit
- Funding flows through the village

12 • Ask

- Looking for: co-founder intro, advisors, patient funders
- Honest critique welcome
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